Tomislav Mesarić

Zagreb, Croatia | +385 1 555 0142 | tomislav.mesaric@example.com

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Butcher and meat counter professional with hands-on experience in beef, pork and lamb carcass breakdown, boning, trimming and portioning. Skilled in fresh sausage production, customer advice, FIFO stock rotation, and HACCP temperature and hygiene checks. Vocationally trained butcher with a basic food hygiene certificate.

EXPERIENCE

Butcher, Mesnica Kod Ante (family butcher shop) | Zagreb | 2019–Present

- Break down 2–3 beef forequarters and 10–12 pork sides per week; bone, trim and portion meat for the counter.
- Prepare about 40 kg of fresh sausage weekly in the busy season, including ćevapi, kobasice, chipolata and lamb merguez.
- Developed the shop's lamb merguez recipe and adjusted the ćevapi mix to 70% beef / 30% lamb based on customer feedback; the ćevapi won 2nd place at the Zagreb County craft meat fair in 2023.
- Rotate cold-room stock every morning using FIFO, placing the oldest stock at the front. Keep the cold room at 0–4 °C and record temperature checks for the cold room and display counter twice a day.
- Serve about 120 customers on Saturdays, advising on cuts and cooking times.
- Trained 2 apprentices in knife handling and cleaning routines.
- Prepared whole lambs and suckling pigs for spit-roasting at 3 weddings and about 10 family parties a year (2022–2025), handling ordering, butchering, seasoning and morning delivery.
- Largest catering order: 4 lambs and 2 pigs for a 180-guest wedding in Samobor (2024).
- Ran a 6-week dry-ageing trial of beef ribs at 21 and 28 days, keeping weight-loss and temperature records. The shop now sells dry-aged rib by pre-order, about 15 kg a month.

Counter Assistant, Tržnica Dolac meat hall stall | Zagreb | 2015–2019

- Served customers, weighed and priced orders, operated the till and completed cash-up.
- Cleaned and sanitised slicers, mincers and the counter at closing.
- Wrote a one-page closing and cleaning checklist after a hygiene inspection remark; it remains in use at the stall.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATES

Vocational Certificate: Butcher (3-year programme), Food Trades School Zagreb | 2015
HACCP Basic Food Hygiene Certificate | 2021; renewed 2024

ADDITIONAL PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Preparing for the master butcher exam (majstorski ispit); exam planned for spring 2027.

SKILLS

Carcass breakdown (beef, pork and lamb) · Boning and trimming · Portioning · Fresh sausage making · FIFO stock rotation · HACCP temperature and hygiene checks · Knife sharpening · Mincer and bandsaw operation · Customer service and advice · Paper wrapping · Cash handling

LANGUAGES

Croatian (native) · English (good) · German (basic)